

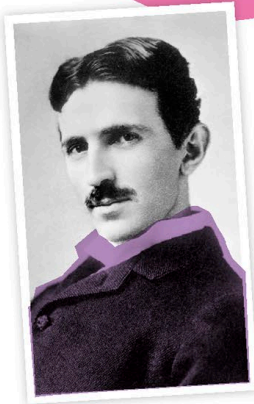
May

16

1888

Electric talk

In a lecture to engineers in New York City, USA, Serbian-American inventor Nikola Tesla demonstrated his new alternating-current power system, which is still in use today.



Also on this day

1832 Chilean miner **Juan Godoy** discovered large amounts of silver in the ground near Copiapó, Chile, sparking the Chilean Silver Rush.

1929 The **Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences** gave out its first annual awards – nicknamed the Oscars – in California, USA.

1985 British scientists working in **Antarctica** announced that they had found an 18.9 million sq km (7.3 million sq mile) hole in the ozone layer over the South Pole.

Kick volleyball

Teams from Penang, Malaysia, played in the first official competition of Sepak Takraw – a fast-paced game of foot volleyball popular in Southeast Asia, in which players use their feet, knees, or heads to get a ball over a net and score.

1945



Dambuster raid

During World War II, British planes unleashed a new weapon – “bouncing bombs” that skimmed across water. The bombs destroyed a series of dams in Germany’s Ruhr region, flooding the area and killing 1,300 people.

1943

Born this day

1966 Janet Jackson, Black American singer and actor. This successful pop and R&B star has sold more than 100 million records.